

Robert Annabel

r.w.b.annabel@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/robert-annabel | Sydney, NSW, Australia

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate governance and institutional investors; industrial organisation and firm strategy; econometric theory and causal inference; theories of the firm and firm objectives.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Active learning; extrinsic and intrinsic motivation for learning; use of AI and educational technology for learning; assessment in the presence of AI

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Lecturer, School of Economics, University of Sydney, Sydney, Australia *2025–present*

Sem. 1, 2026 Lecturer and Unit Coordinator, Financial Economics (ECON6021, postgraduate). Asset pricing theory and the microeconomics of financial markets; responsible for curriculum development, delivery and administration, and assessment design.

Sem. 1, 2026 Lecturer and Unit Coordinator, Economics Research Project (ECON7030, postgraduate, Industrial Organisation stream). Capstone research unit in which students produce a 2,000-word independent research report; lead the IO stream where I guide students with their research project; coordinate with lecturers of concurrent streams to administer unit.

Sem. 2, 2025 Lecturer, Microeconomic Theory (ECON5001, postgraduate). Consumer theory, firm theory, market structure, and market interactions.

Sem. 2, 2025 Lecturer, Economics Research Project (ECON7030, postgraduate, Industrial Organisation stream).

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy, Economics *2021–2025*
School of Economics, UNSW Business School, University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia.

Thesis: Essays on Institutional Investors and Firm Behavior.

Supervisors: Prof. Arghya Ghosh, A/Prof. Anthony Asher, A/Prof. Scott Donald, Prof. Hazel Bateman.

Master of Pre-Doctoral Business Studies *2020*
UNSW Business School, University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia.

Bachelor of Actuarial Studies (Honours, Class I) *2019*
School of Risk and Actuarial Studies, University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia.

Thesis: The Exercise of Voting Rights by Superannuation Funds Across Different Investment Options.

Supervisors: A/Prof. Anthony Asher, A/Prof. Scott Donald.

Bachelor of Actuarial Studies (Co-Op Scholar; major in *Finance*) *2013–2016*
School of Risk and Actuarial Studies, University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia.

RESEARCH OUTPUT

Working Papers

- [1] Annabel, R., A. Asher, and A. Ghosh (2022). “Company-Level GHG Emissions and an Institutional Investor’s Active Ownership Objective: Long-Term Shareholder, Socially Responsible Investor, Common Owner or Stakeholder-Oriented Shareholder?” *SSRN Working Paper* 4288009. Available at: ssrn.com/abstract=4288009.

PhD Thesis

- [1] Annabel, R. (2025). *Essays on Institutional Investors and Firm Behavior*. PhD thesis, School of Economics, UNSW Business School. DOI: [10.26190/unsworks/31326](https://doi.org/10.26190/unsworks/31326).

Honours Thesis

- [1] Annabel, R. (2019). *The Exercise of Voting Rights by Superannuation Funds Across Different Investment Options*. Honours thesis, School of Risk and Actuarial Studies, UNSW Business School. Supervisors: A/Prof. Anthony Asher, A/Prof. Scott Donald.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & INVITED TALKS

Conference Presentations

15th Australasian Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics, Monash Business School, Port Stephens, NSW.	<i>Apr. 2026</i>
Econometric Society 2023 Australasia Meeting, School of Economics, UNSW Business School, Sydney.	<i>Aug. 2023</i>
Inaugural Markets, Contracts and Organizations Conference, Research School of Economics, Australian National University, Canberra.	<i>Jun. 2023</i>
29th Global Finance Conference, Global Finance Association and University of Minho, Braga, Portugal.	<i>Jun. 2022</i>
12th Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference, Monash Business School, Melbourne.	<i>Apr. 2022</i>
29th Colloquium on Pensions and Retirement Research, CEPAR and School of Risk & Actuarial Studies, UNSW Business School, Sydney.	<i>Dec. 2021</i>

Invited Presentations

Microeconomic Theory Seminar, University of Sydney, Sydney.	<i>May 2026</i>
Reserve Bank of Australia and Australian Prudential Regulation Authority (Brian Gray Scholarship programme), Sydney.	<i>Feb. 2024</i>

Invited Attendance

New Frontiers in Corporate Governance: Corporate Governance with Externalities, Financial Markets Group, London School of Economics, London.	<i>Oct. 2023</i>
--	------------------

SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

Brian Gray Scholarship Reserve Bank of Australia (RBA) and Australian Prudential Regulation Authority (APRA). Competitive national award; includes invited presentations to the RBA and APRA.	<i>2023–2024</i>
Ryoichi Sasakawa Young Leaders Fellowship Fund Scholarship Nippon Foundation and Tokyo Foundation for Policy Research.	<i>2021–2024</i>
State Super Academic Scholarship , State Super	<i>2021</i>
Australian Government Research Training Program (RTP) Scholarship Commonwealth Government of Australia.	<i>2021–2024</i>
Nominated, UNSW Business School Award for Teaching Excellence in Tutoring	<i>2023</i>
UNSW Co-Op Scholarship University of New South Wales.	<i>2013–2016</i>

TEACHING INNOVATIONS AND CURRICULUM DESIGN

Cogniti AI Integration — ECON6021 Financial Economics, University of Sydney Deployed Cogniti AI as Socratic tutor, direct answer tool, and question generator.	<i>Sem. 1, 2026</i>
BYOD Digital Assessment — ECON6021 Financial Economics, University of Sydney Implemented BYOD digital examinations using Respondus Lockdown Browser for the in-semester test and final examination.	<i>Sem. 1, 2026</i>
Industrial Organisation Stream Development — ECON7030 Economics Research Project, University of Sydney Developed the IO stream from scratch for this Master of Economics capstone; created topic framing, reading lists, lecture and tutorial notes, assessments and assessment rubrics.	<i>Sem. 2, 2025</i>
Actuarial Practice Tutorial Manual — ACTL4002/5200 Actuarial Theory and Practice B, UNSW Wrote the tutorial manual for the undergraduate and postgraduate offerings.	<i>T2, 2025</i>
Probability and Statistics Course Redevelopment — ACTL2131 Probability and Mathematical Statistics, UNSW Sat on the redevelopment committee; re-organised course structure, updated lecture notes, and restructured the tutorial manual.	<i>T1, 2024</i>
Game Theory Tutorial Materials — ECON2112 Game Theory and Business Strategy, UNSW Developed tutorial questions and slides used across all tutorial streams; wrote final examination questions.	<i>T1, 2022–2025</i>

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Consultant → Senior Consultant , Banking and Capital Markets, EY, Sydney Implementation of credit risk models (SAS) for a major Australian bank; revenue and profit reporting; internal training delivery.	<i>Jul. 2016 – Jul. 2018</i>
Intern (Co-Op) , General Insurance, KPMG, Sydney Markov chain and GLM modelling for bus punctuality prediction.	<i>Jan. – Jun. 2016</i>
Intern (Co-Op) , Defined Benefit Superannuation Consulting, Russell Investments, Sydney Valuation of defined benefit liabilities; multiple decrement models; scenario analysis.	<i>Jul. – Dec. 2015</i>
Intern (Co-Op) , Actuarial and Risk, PricewaterhouseCoopers, Sydney Valuation of dust disease liabilities.	<i>Dec. 2013 – Feb. 2014</i>

RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

Each of the research assistant roles below was on a casual basis and involved 20-50hrs of employment.

Research Assistant to A/Prof. Scott Donald and A/Prof. Anthony Asher, Centre for Law, Markets and Regulation, UNSW Literature synthesis and modelling for submission to the Australian Government Retirement Income Review.	<i>2019–2020</i>
Research Assistant to Prof. Hazel Bateman, UNSW Literature review for experimental investigation of superannuation members' responses to market volatility.	<i>2020</i>
Research Assistant to A/Prof. Katja Hanewald, UNSW Literature review for empirical study on the impact of retirement age reform in China.	<i>2020</i>
Research Assistant to A/Prof. Anthony Asher, UNSW Interdisciplinary literature review on organisational corruption.	<i>2020</i>

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Unit/Course Coordinator or Lecturer-In-Charge

ECON6021 Financial Economics (postgraduate, University of Sydney) Asset pricing theory and the microeconomics of financial markets; responsible for curriculum delivery, assessment design, and coordination across concurrent offerings.	<i>Sem. 1, 2026</i>
ECON7030 Economics Research Project (postgraduate, IO stream, University of Sydney) Capstone research unit; students produce a 2,000-word independent research report. Lead the IO stream and coordinate with lecturers of concurrent streams.	<i>Sem. 1, 2026</i>

Lecturer

ECON6021 Financial Economics (postgraduate, University of Sydney) *Sem. 1, 2026*
 Asset pricing theory and the microeconomics of financial markets.

ECON5001 Microeconomic Theory (postgraduate, University of Sydney) *Sem. 2, 2025*
 Consumer theory, firm theory, market structure, and market interactions.

ECON7030 Economics Research Project (postgraduate, IO stream, University of Sydney) *Sem. 2, 2025*
 Capstone research unit; students produce a 2,000-word independent research report; IO stream.

COMM5601 Interdisciplinary Applications of Analytics Techniques *T1, 2024–2025*
 (postgraduate, UNSW)
 Guest Lecturer, Time Series.

ACTL2131 Probability and Mathematical Statistics (UNSW) *T1, 2024*
 Co-Lecturer; probability distributions, estimation, hypothesis testing, and regression.

Thesis Examination

Honours Thesis Examiner, School of Economics, University of Sydney *2025*
 Assessed and graded Honours theses in economics; topics included organisation theory and econometric methods for measuring inequality.

Head Tutor

ECON2112 Game Theory and Business Strategy (UNSW) *T1, 2022–2024*
 Normal-form and extensive-form games; Nash, subgame-perfect, and Bayesian equilibrium; repeated games and reputation.

Tutor

ECON2206 Introductory Econometrics (UNSW) *T1, 2025*
 Multiple linear regression, cross-sectional, panel, and time-series data.
 Software: Stata.

ECON2112 Game Theory and Business Strategy (UNSW) *T1, 2022–2025*
 Normal-form and extensive-form games; Nash, subgame-perfect, and Bayesian equilibrium; repeated games and reputation.

ACTL4002 Actuarial Theory and Practice B (UNSW) *T2, 2025*
 Actuarial management of risk-based financial products; product development and pricing; liability valuation; solvency and capital management; Actuarial Control Cycle.

COMM3501 Quantitative Business Analytics (UNSW) *T2, 2025*
 Predictive analytics and statistical learning for business applications; regression, classification, supervised and unsupervised learning; communication of data-driven insights.

ACTL2131 Probability and Mathematical Statistics (UNSW) *T1, 2021–2024*
 Probability distributions, moment generating functions, estimation, hypothesis testing, and regression.

ECON3210 Big Data Econometrics (UNSW) *T2, 2024*
 Regularisation, regression trees, IV, DiD, Double Machine Learning.
 Software: R.

ECON3203 Econometric Theory and Methods (UNSW) Regression, regularisation, GAMs, KNN, neural networks, NLP. Software: Python.	<i>T3, 2024</i>
ACTL5110 Statistical Machine Learning for Risk and Actuarial Applications (postgraduate, UNSW) GLMs, regularisation, decision trees, clustering, PCA. Software: R.	<i>T2, 2023</i>
ACTL3151 Life Contingencies (UNSW) Multiple decrement models; present value of contingent cashflows.	<i>T1, 2023</i>
ZZBU5611 Strategic Decision Making (UNSW) Game-theoretic and decision-analytic approaches to strategic business decisions.	<i>Hex. 2, 2023</i>
ACTL3182 Asset-Liability and Derivative Management (UNSW) Derivative valuation and portfolio management techniques.	<i>T3, 2019; T3, 2022</i>
ACTL4001/4002 Actuarial Theory and Practice A/B (UNSW) Actuarial management of financial institutions and products; data accuracy; model development; professionalism.	<i>T1, 2019–2020 (A); T2, 2019–2020 (B)</i>

References available upon request.